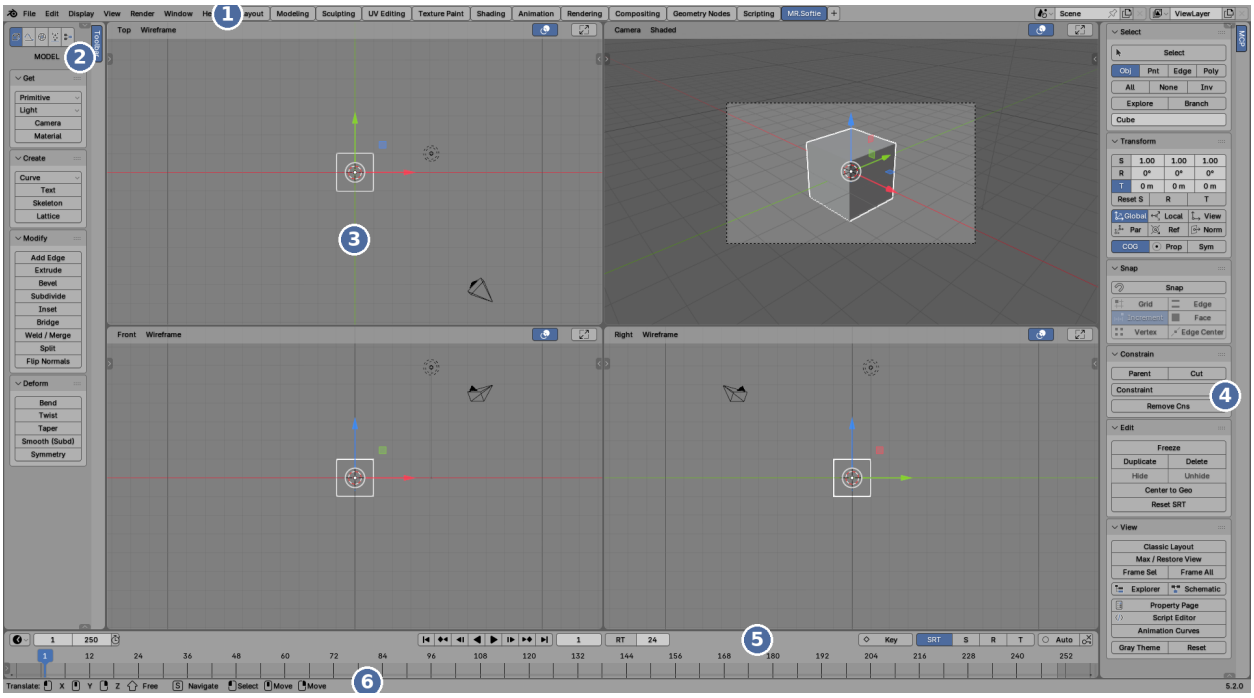
MR.Softie

Setup and quick-start guide, version 2.3.0: the classic SI-style workflow, built on Blender



1 Menu bar
2 Module toolbar
3 Four viewports
4 MCP
5 Timeline strip
6 Mouse / script line

You need **Blender 4.2 or newer** (tested on 5.2) and an internet connection for the install. It takes about five minutes, and after that updates arrive on their own.

What you get

Layout	Module toolbar, four independent viewports, the MCP, a classic menu bar, timeline strip and gray theme, in their own MR.Softie workspace tab.
Workflow	Supra-mode V / C / X / Space tools, Left / Middle / Right = X / Y / Z, S to navigate, Tweak, Raycast, property pages, Explorer and Schematic.
Construction	Modeling / Shape / Animation / Secondary Shape regions in every object's stack, a construction mode for new operators, and Freeze M.
Modeling	Add Edge, Split Edge, Weld Points / Edges, Bridge, Slice, Add Polygon, Loop / Ring, Collapse, Dissolve, Filter Points, Symmetrize, Poly Reduction and the usual extrude / bevel / bridge.
Animation	Save Key on marked parameters (K), auto-key, animation layers with weights, Mixer clips, Animation Editor.
Rigging	Draw Chain with an IK effector, FK / IK blend, constraint presets (Position, Orientation, Direction, Pose, Scaling, Path), Set Envelope, Weight Paint.
ICE	Compounds built as editable Geometry Nodes: Emit, Particles (floor and collision), Swarm, Strands, Strand Dynamics (length-keeping, collides with the body), Turbulence, Jitter, Push.
Rendering	Material presets (Phong, Glass, Chrome, Car Paint...), textures, Material Manager, passes with presets, partitions with matte / indirect overrides, render channels, a render region per pass.

Install

1

Let Blender go online

Open Blender and go to **Edit > Preferences > Get Extensions**. If it shows **Allow Online Access**, click it. (It's also under **System > Network**.)

2

Add the MR.Softie repository

On the Get Extensions page, open the **Repositories** dropdown in the top-right corner and click **+ > Add Remote Repository**.

Paste this URL and turn on **Check for Updates on Startup**:

```
https://raw.githubusercontent.com/JavTsPlayground/mr-softie/main/download/index.json
```

3 Install it

Search for **MR.Softie** on the Get Extensions page and click **Install**.

Installed it from a zip before? Uninstall that copy first (Preferences > Add-ons, arrow next to MR.Softie, Uninstall), so the two don't clash.

4 Build the workspace

Close Preferences. With the mouse over the 3D viewport press **N**, click the **MCP** tab on the right edge of the sidebar, and click **Classic Layout** in its View section.

You now have a **MR.Softie** workspace tab at the top. From then on, just click that tab.

Want it to look like the picture? Click **Gray Theme** in the same section (**Reset** goes back to Blender's theme).

5 Optional: start Blender straight into MR.Softie

In the add-on's preferences (Preferences > Add-ons > MR.Softie) click **Install App Template**, or use **Edit > Install MR.Softie App Template**.

MR Softie then appears under **File > New** and on the splash screen.

6 Optional: pick your options

In the add-on's preferences: **Classic Hotkeys** (off gives you Blender's keys back), **SRT Mouse Buttons** (Left / Middle / Right = X / Y / Z by default), **SRT Manipulator** and **Number Keys Open Editors**.

Find your way around

1 Menu bar	File, Edit, Display, View, Render, Window, Help. **View** opens every editor in its own floating window: Explorer, Schematic, Property Page, Script Editor, Animation Editor, Mixer, Render Tree, ICE Tree and more.
2 Module toolbar	The five icons at the top switch module: Model, Animate, Render, Simulate ICE and Custom (keys 1 to 6); the current one is named underneath. Custom holds your own toolbars: Add Command makes a button from the last command, Add Script from the Script Editor. Each has its own stack of commands. Get > Primitive is where new objects come from.
3 Four viewports	Top, Camera, Front and Right, each with its own view and display menus, a maximize button and memo cams **1 2 3 4**: click an empty one to remember the view, a lit one to go back to it (the arrow next to them stores over or forgets).
4 MCP	Select (with a selection filter: All, Geom, Light, Cam, Null, Skel), Transform, Snap, Constrain, Edit, View and Layers (scene layers: show, select, render per layer).
5 Timeline strip	Start / End, playback, current frame, RT (real-time playback), then **Key** (red when keyed on this frame), the marked parameters (SRT / S / R / T) and Auto-key.
6 Status line	What the mouse buttons do right now, and the last command you ran (click it to open the Script Editor).

Hotkeys

They work while the mouse is over a 3D viewport.

Space	Object selection (also leaves point / edge / polygon mode).
V / C / X	Translate / Rotate / Scale. Tap to switch tools; hold for a temporary tool.
in V / C / X	Left / Middle / Right drag = X / Y / Z. Shift + Left drag = free.
T / E / Y	Point / Edge / Polygon selection.
S + Left / Middle / Right	Pan / Dolly / Orbit.
F / A	Frame selection / Frame all.
Ctrl+A / Ctrl+D / Ctrl+Y	Select all / Duplicate / Redo.
Enter	Property page for the selection.
M	Tweak: drag a point, edge, polygon or object to move it.
****	Add Edge (cut new edges) in component mode.
K	Save Key on the marked parameters.
Alt+4	Script Editor: command log above a script editor.
Q / Shift+Q	Render Region: drag a live render box in a viewport / remove it.
Alt + Right click	Context menu.
1 / 2 / 3 / 4 / 5 / 6	Toolbar module: Model / Animate / Render / Simulate / ICE / Custom.
7 / 8 / 9 / 0	Render Tree / Explorer / Schematic / Animation Editor.

Ten-minute tour

1 Model

Model > Get > Primitive > Cube. Press **V** and drag with the left, middle and right buttons to move it along X, Y and Z. Press **Y** for polygons, select one, then Poly Mesh > Extrude. Tools > **Weld Points**: drag one corner onto another; **Split Edge**: click an edge to add a point. **Space** takes you back to objects.

2 Animate

Go to frame 1 and press **K**. Go to frame 24, move the cube, press **K** again, and press Play on the timeline strip. Animate > Layers > **New** adds a layer: move the cube up at frame 12 and press K, and the bounce rides on top of the slide. Mixer > **Store Clip** turns animation into a clip on the Mixer.

3 ICE

Press **5** for the ICE module, select the cube and click **Grow Strands**, then **Strand Dynamics**, and press Play: springy hair. Or click **Swarm** for a flock, **Simulate Particles** for falling points. Settings are in the modifier (Property Editor > wrench tab); **ICE Tree** opens the node tree.

4 Render

Press **3**. Get > Material > **Chrome**, then Get > Texture > **Checker**, and open the Render Tree to see what it built. Press **Q** over the Camera view and drag a box around the cube for a live render of just that part (Shift+Q removes it). Passes > **Preset** > Depth makes a depth pass. Partitions > **New from Selection** puts the cube in its own partition; its toggles show or hide it, make it a matte or indirect-only, in the current pass. **Render** renders just that pass.

Updating and sharing

With the repository added, Blender checks for a new version every time it starts; install updates from Preferences > Get Extensions. To share MR.Softie, send people the repository URL above, or the project page: **github.com/JavTsPlayground/mr-softie**.

If something doesn't work

MR.Softie isn't in Get Extensions	Check that online access is allowed and the repository URL is exactly the one above, then choose **Check for Updates** from the small down-arrow menu at the top right of Get Extensions.
No MCP tab	Check the add-on is ticked in Preferences > Add-ons, then press N with the mouse over the 3D viewport.
Columns look the wrong width	The layout is tuned at 1920 x 1080. Click **Classic Layout** again to snap the columns back.
Hotkeys do nothing	Turn on **Classic Hotkeys** in the add-on's preferences, and keep the mouse over a 3D viewport.
A Blender key I need is gone	MR.Softie takes over Space, S, C, V, X, E, A, F, T, Y, K, M, Enter, Q and the number keys in the 3D view. Turn Classic Hotkeys (or Number Keys Open Editors) off to get Blender's back.
Middle drag doesn't work	Use a three-button mouse; Blender's 3-button emulation conflicts with the classic keys.
A simulation doesn't move	Simulations advance frame by frame: press Play, or Bake. Jumping around the timeline doesn't simulate.
Uninstall	Click **Reset** in the MCP's View section if you applied the theme, then Preferences > Add-ons > arrow next to MR.Softie > Uninstall.

MR.Softie is free and open source (GPL-3.0-or-later). It isn't affiliated with or endorsed by Autodesk, and all names, icons and artwork in it are original.